Algebraic Geometry

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Contents

0.1 Plan 1
0.2 Resources 1
0.3 Why scheme theory? 1

Lecture 1

0.1 Plan

1. Basics of sheaves of topological spaces
2. Definitions of schemes and of morphisms
3. Properties of schemes (the algebraic geometry analogues of compactness)
4. Rapid introduction to the cohomology of sheaves

0.2 Resources

1. Course webpage - Google Dhruv
2. Books:
   - Hartshorne - Algebraic Geometry, Chapter 2 and $\varepsilon\times$Chapter 3
   - Vakil - Rising Sea, good online (free) alternative
   - Eisenbud-Harris - Geometry of schemes
3. Four examples sheets on webpage
4. SAGES - Look on Dhruv's webpage

0.3 Why scheme theory?

Moduli theory – It is better to study families of varieties than one at a time. Or better, all varieties of a given type at the same time.

Examples of moduli: The set of all lines in $\mathbb{P}^2$. A line in $\mathbb{P}^2$ is

$$\{aX_0 + bX_1 + cX_2 = 0\}$$

In particular, as lines are paramterised by the triple (a, b, c), we have a correspondence

$$\mathbb{P}^2_{\text{dual}} = \text{lines in } \mathbb{P}^2 \leftrightarrow \mathbb{P}^2$$

The same logic applies for degree d hypersurface in $\mathbb{P}^n$, and we get

$$\text{degree } d \text{ hypersufaces in } \mathbb{P}^n \leftrightarrow \mathbb{P}^N$$

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where $N = \binom{n+d}{d} - 1$. However, there is something wrong with this picture. Some polynomials are of the form

$$f = f_1^2 f_2$$

But in this case,

$$\mathbb{V}(f) = \mathbb{V}(f_1 f_2)$$

and $f_1 f_2$ is (in general) not of degree d.

A solution Take $U_d \subseteq \mathbb{P}^N$, where

$$[f] \in U_d \iff f \text{ has no repeated factors}$$

But U_d is not compact.

Output of scheme theory for a fixed projective space $\mathbb{P}^n$, we obtain a space

$$\text{subvarieties of } \mathbb{P}^n \leftrightarrow \text{Var}(\mathbb{P}^n) \subsetneq \text{Hilb}(\mathbb{P}^n) \leftrightarrow \text{ subschemes of } \mathbb{P}^n$$

where $\text{Hilb}(\mathbb{P}^n)$ is the Hilbert scheme of $\mathbb{P}^n$, which is compact in the Euclidean topology. That is, the limit of varieties need not be a variety, but limits of schemes are always schemes.

In scheme theory,

$$\mathbb{V}(X_0 + X_1 + X_2) \text{ and } \mathbb{V}((X_0 + X_1 + X_2)^2)$$

are not isomorphic as schemes.

Weil conjectures Fix $f \in \mathbb{Z}[X_0, \dots, X_{n+1}]$ homogeneous. We have

$$X = \mathbb{V}(f) \subseteq \mathbb{P}^{n+1}_{\mathbb{C}}$$

We will assume that X is smooth. That is, X is a (complex) manifold. In particular, X is a compact topological space, and so we have numbers $b_0(X), \dots, b_{2n}(X)$ called the Betti numbers, where

$$b_i(X) = \text{rank}(H_i(X, \mathbb{Z}))$$

In particular, we have the Euler characteristic $\chi(X)$.

On the other hand, fix a prime number p, and let

$$N_m = \text{number of solutions to } f \text{ in } \mathbb{F}_{p^m} = \left|X(\mathbb{F}_{p^m})\right|$$

Define the Weil ζ function

$$\zeta(X; t) = \exp\left(\sum_m \frac{N_m}{m} t^m\right)$$

Theorem 0.1 (Weil conjectures, Grothendieck).

1. $\zeta(X; t)$ is a rational function in t
2. Moreover,
$$\zeta(X; t) = \frac{P_0(t) P_2(t) \cdots P_{2n}(t)}{P_1(t) P_3(t) \cdots P_{2n-1}(t)}$$
where $\deg(P_i(t)) = b_i(X)$.

Upshot: The proof is (fundamentally) via scheme theory. We need a space $\mathfrak{X}$ which interpolates geometry over $\mathbb{C}$ and geometry over finite fields.

Index

Weil conjectures, 2